

FREE READER BONUS · QUICK-START CHEAT SHEET

The Method *on one page*

Keep it on the counter.
Tick each step as you go.

1 Prime the wick ☐

- Cut food-safe cotton wick about 1½ in (4 cm) longer than the mold is tall, a little more if you'll wrap it around a holder.
- Dip it in melted butter (or the recipe's own fat) and pull it straight.
- Lay it on parchment and chill 5–10 minutes, until stiff.
- **Cheese candle?** Twist 3 strands together first: the Cheese Wick.

2 Set the wick, before filling ☐

- **Paper Cup Knot** (paper cups, tubes): thread the wick on a large-eyed needle through the center of the bottom, knot it underneath, then wrap it twice around a toothpick pushed through the sides near the rim.
- **Top Hang** (ramekins, glasses, silicone): hang it from a toothpick, clothespin, or chopstick so it just touches the bottom. Nudge it back to the middle as you fill.
- **Skewer Hole** (logs, balls): once the candle is firm, make a channel with a skewer and slide the wick in.

3 Mix in the flavors ☐

- Soften the butter, don't melt it: soft enough to press with a finger, like thick frosting.
- Beat until creamy, smooth, and a shade paler.
- Mix in the flavors. Chocolate goes in cooled until barely warm; cheese goes in patted dry.

4 Fill the mold ☐

- Spoon it in a little at a time, pressing out air pockets with the back of the spoon.
- Tall, narrow molds: pipe it in from the bottom up.

5 Chill ☐

- At least 3 hours in the fridge, or 1 hour in the freezer, until firm all the way through.

6 Unmold and plate ☐

- **Paper cup:** snip the knot, then peel the paper away in strips.
- **Silicone:** freeze 15 minutes, then push it out from the bottom.
- **Ramekin or cup:** nothing to unmold; just wipe the rim.
- Set it on a heatproof plate with a rim.

7 Decorate (optional) ☐

- Let it stand 10 minutes, until the surface turns tacky, then press on herbs or roll it in a crust.
- Keep the top clear around the wick. Decorating takes practice; skip it if it gives you trouble.

8 Light and dip ☐

- Let it stand about 10 minutes. Coconut oil candles go straight from the fridge.
- Trim the wick to about ½ in, or 1 in for cheese candles, and light it from the side with a long lighter.
- Dip around the edges of the pool, away from the flame.
- The wick isn't edible: remove it before the last bite.

BLOW IT OUT WHEN…

the pool gets low · little ones are at the table · you leave the room, even for a minute · it smokes or sputters a lot. Never leave it burning unattended.

THE 2-HOUR RULE

Perishable candles go back in the fridge within 2 hours, or 1 hour above 90°F (32°C).

QUICK-START CHEAT SHEET

Before You Start

Everything you need, gathered in one place. No craft store required.

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THE GEAR

- ☐ A mold: sturdy paper cup (8–12 oz), cardboard tube, ramekin, or silicone mold
- ☐ Food-safe wick: 100% cotton or hemp, undyed and unscented, or plain cotton kitchen twine
- ☐ Something to hold the wick: toothpicks, a clothespin, or a chopstick or wooden skewer
- ☐ A large-eyed needle, for the Paper Cup Knot
- ☐ A bowl and a spatula
- ☐ A small saucepan or a microwave-safe bowl
- ☐ Sharp scissors
- ☐ A long lighter or long matches
- ☐ A heatproof plate with a rim

NICE TO HAVE

- ☐ Parchment paper, for chilling wicks and lining tubes
- ☐ A kitchen scale
- ☐ Tweezers, for pressed herbs and flowers
- ☐ A piping bag or zip-top bag, for tall, narrow molds

FOR CHEESE CANDLES

- ☐ A food processor or a sturdy whisk
- ☐ For a whole brie: a small knife, a spoon, and a cocktail pick

THE PANTRY

- ☐ Unsalted butter: one cup is two sticks (226 g)
- ☐ Or another fat from the recipe: ghee, plant-based butter sticks, refined coconut oil, bacon fat
- ☐ The flavors on the recipe's list
- ☐ Something to dip, from the recipe's *Dip with* line

NEVER

- × Colored, scented, or treated craft wicks, or wicks with a metal core
- × Liquor on the candle or near the flame: use an extract
- × Fresh fruit or juice: use freeze-dried fruit and zest

MY FIRST CANDLE

Recipe _____ Page _____

Mold _____

Wick technique: ☐ Paper Cup Knot ☐ Top Hang ☐ Skewer Hole

Make it by _____ Serving on _____

Dippers to buy _____

_____

START HERE

Your first time? The Garlic & Herb Butter Candle (p. 26) teaches every move in the book.

Counter cards: cut along the dashed lines. Two cards, 3.5 × 7 in, to keep by the mixing bowl.

QUICK-START CARD 1

The Method at a Glance

Tick each step as you go.

- ☐ **1 Prime the wick.** Cut it 1½ in longer than the mold, dip in melted butter, chill 5–10 min until stiff.
- ☐ **2 Set the wick.** Paper cup: needle through the bottom, knot below, toothpick on top. Other molds: hang it from the top.
- ☐ **3 Mix.** Soften the butter (don't melt it), beat until pale, mix in the flavors.
- ☐ **4 Fill.** Spoon in a little at a time, pressing out air pockets.
- ☐ **5 Chill.** At least 3 hours in the fridge, or 1 hour in the freezer.
- ☐ **6 Unmold.** Snip the knot, peel the cup, set it on a heatproof plate.
- ☐ **7 Decorate.** Optional: after 10 minutes, once the surface is tacky.
- ☐ **8 Rest and trim.** About 10 minutes at room temperature. Wick to ½ in (1 in for cheese).
- ☐ **9 Light and dip.** Dip around the edges. Remove the wick before the last bite.

Cheese candle? Twist 3 strands of wick together before priming.

The Edible Candles Cookbook · Gahema Press

QUICK-START CARD 2

Before You Start

Your shopping and gear checklist.

GEAR

- ☐ Mold: paper cup, ramekin, or silicone mold
- ☐ Food-safe cotton wick or kitchen twine
- ☐ Toothpicks, clothespin, or chopstick
- ☐ Large-eyed needle
- ☐ Bowl, spatula, small saucepan
- ☐ Scissors and a long lighter
- ☐ Heatproof plate with a rim

PANTRY

- ☐ Butter (or your fat): _____
- ☐ Flavors: _____
- ☐ Something to dip: _____

Recipe I'm making:

_____

_____

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